



# Sinhala ASR Text Cleaning On SinLlama

## Training Mode Documentation

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### QLoRA Fine-Tuning On SinLlama (Llama 3 8B) for Sinhala ASR Text Correction

Base Model: SAWithanage/SinLlama-Llama-3-8B-Merged

Fine-Tuning Method: QLoRA using Unsloth and TRL SFTTrainer

Prepared from: SinLlama\_QLoRA\_v2.ipynb

Project: Sinhala ASR Transcript Correction

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## 1. Purpose of This Document

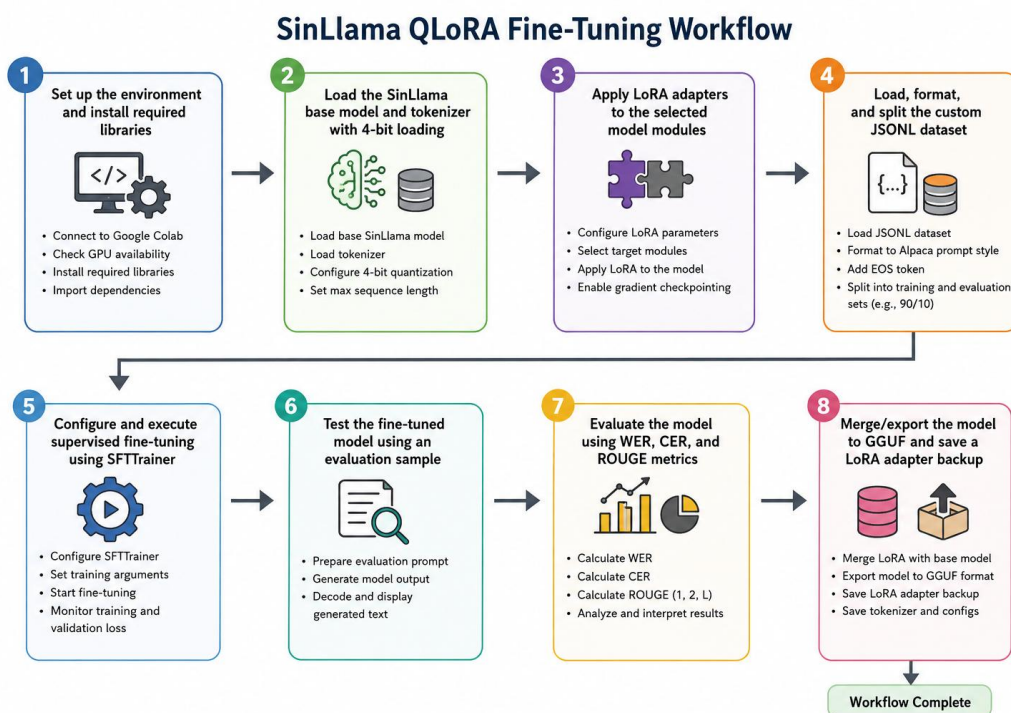
This document provides a step-by-step guide to the training mode used to fine-tune the SinLlama model for Sinhala Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) text correction. It explains the environment setup, model loading, QLoRA configuration, dataset preparation, training configuration, training execution, testing, evaluation, and model export.

The document is intended to help another team member understand and reproduce the workflow using the same training notebook and required resources.

## 2. Training Workflow

The training workflow implemented in the notebook is shown below:

| Step | Activity                                                      |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Set up the environment and install required libraries         |
| 2    | Load the SinLlama base model and tokenizer with 4-bit loading |
| 3    | Apply LoRA adapters to the selected model modules             |
| 4    | Load, format, and split the custom JSONL dataset              |
| 5    | Configure and execute supervised fine-tuning using SFTTrainer |
| 6    | Test the fine-tuned model using an evaluation sample          |
| 7    | Evaluate the model using WER, CER, and ROUGE metrics          |
| 8    | Merge/export the model to GGUF and save a LoRA adapter backup |



### 3. Training Environment and Requirements

The notebook was prepared for execution in Google Colab using a Tesla T4 GPU. The implementation uses Unsloth to support memory-efficient QLoRA fine-tuning of the SinLlama model.

| Component             | Configuration / Requirement            |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Execution environment | Google Colab                           |
| GPU                   | Tesla T4                               |
| Base model            | SAWithanage/SinLlama-Llama-3-8B-Merged |
| Fine-tuning approach  | QLoRA with LoRA adapters               |
| Main framework        | Unsloth FastLanguageModel              |
| Training framework    | TRL SFTTrainer                         |
| Dataset format        | JSONL                                  |

### 4. Step 1 – Environment Setup and Library Installation

#### 4.1 Objective

The first step prepares the execution environment by installing Unsloth and the additional libraries required for training, parameter-efficient fine-tuning, quantization, acceleration, and dataset processing.

#### 4.2 Relevant Code

```
%%capture
!pip install unsloth
!pip install --no-deps "xformers<0.0.27" "trl<0.9.0" peft accelerate bitsandbytes datasets
```

#### 4.3 Explanation

| Library      | Role in the workflow                                                 |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unsloth      | Provides memory-efficient model loading and fine-tuning utilities.   |
| xformers     | Installed for the configured Colab/T4 environment.                   |
| TRL          | Provides SFTTrainer and SFTConfig for supervised fine-tuning.        |
| PEFT         | Supports parameter-efficient fine-tuning methods such as LoRA.       |
| Accelerate   | Supports accelerated training execution.                             |
| bitsandbytes | Supports low-bit quantization and the 8-bit optimizer configuration. |
| datasets     | Loads and processes the JSONL dataset.                               |

#### Step 1: Setup and Installation

First, we install the unsloth package along with its dependencies. Since we are using a Tesla T4 GPU on Google Colab, we will also need to install xformers (Flash Attention) to optimize memory usage.

```
%%capture
# 1. Install Unsloth from the stable PyPI release
!pip install unsloth

# 2. Force the installation of specific compatible dependencies for Colab T4
!pip install --no-deps "xformers<0.0.27" "trl<0.9.0" peft accelerate bitsandbytes datasets
```



## 6. Step 3 – Apply LoRA Adapters

### 6.1 Objective

LoRA adapters are added to selected projection modules of the base model so that fine-tuning can be performed through parameter-efficient adapters instead of updating the complete base model.

### 6.2 Relevant Code

```
model = FastLanguageModel.get_peft_model(
    model,
    r=16,
    target_modules=["q_proj", "k_proj", "v_proj", "o_proj",
                   "gate_proj", "up_proj", "down_proj"],
    lora_alpha=16,
    lora_dropout=0,
    bias="none",
    use_gradient_checkpointing="unsloth",
    random_state=3407,
    use_rslora=False,
    loftq_config=None,
)
```

### 6.3 Configuration Explanation

| Parameter              | Value                                                         |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| LoRA rank (r)          | 16                                                            |
| Target modules         | q_proj, k_proj, v_proj, o_proj, gate_proj, up_proj, down_proj |
| LoRA alpha             | 16                                                            |
| LoRA dropout           | 0                                                             |
| Bias                   | none                                                          |
| Gradient checkpointing | unsloth                                                       |
| Random seed            | 3407                                                          |

The notebook output confirms completion of this step with the message: 'Adapters configured.'

```
... Applying LoRA adapters...
Unsloth 2026.8.1 patched 32 layers with 32 QKV layers, 32 O layers and 32 MLP layers.
Adapters configured.
```

## 7. Step 4 – Load, Format, and Split the Dataset

### 7.1 Objective

The custom JSONL dataset is loaded and transformed into a text field using an Alpaca-style prompt structure. The formatted dataset is then split into training and evaluation subsets.

### 7.2 Dataset Fields

| Field       | Purpose                               |
|-------------|---------------------------------------|
| instruction | Describes the task to be performed.   |
| input       | Contains the noisy Sinhala ASR text.  |
| output      | Contains the expected corrected text. |

### 7.3 Relevant Code

```
from datasets import load_dataset
```

```
dataset_path = "/content/qlora_dataset.jsonl"
raw_dataset = load_dataset(
    "json",
    data_files={"train": dataset_path},
    split="train"
)
```

alpaca\_prompt = """Below is an instruction that describes a task, paired with an input that provides further context. Write a response that appropriately completes the request.

```
### Instruction:
{instruction}
```

```
### Input:
{input}
```

```
### Response:
{output}"""
```

```
EOS_TOKEN = tokenizer.eos_token
```

Each dataset record is formatted using the instruction, input, and expected output. The tokenizer end-of-sequence token is appended to the formatted text.

```
def formatting_prompts_func(examples):
    instructions = examples["instruction"]
    inputs = examples["input"]
    outputs = examples["output"]
    texts = []

    for instruction, input_text, output_text in zip(instructions, inputs, outputs):
        text = alpaca_prompt.format(
            instruction=instruction,
            input=input_text,
            output=output_text
        ) + EOS_TOKEN
        texts.append(text)

    return {"text": texts}
```

### 7.4 Dataset Split

```
formatted_dataset = raw_dataset.map(
    formatting_prompts_func,
    batched=True
)

split_dataset = formatted_dataset.train_test_split(
    test_size=0.10,
    seed=3407
)

train_dataset = split_dataset["train"]
eval_dataset = split_dataset["test"]
```

| Dataset  | Number of Samples | Share |
|----------|-------------------|-------|
| Training | 113               | 90%   |

|            |     |      |
|------------|-----|------|
| Evaluation | 13  | 10%  |
| Total      | 126 | 100% |

```

... Loading dataset from /content/qlora_dataset.jsonl...
Generating train split: 126/0 [00:00<00:00, 1057.22 examples/s]

Map: 100% 126/126 [00:00<00:00, 3333.64 examples/s]
✓ Total samples: 126
  └─ Training samples: 113
    └─ Evaluation (Testing) samples: 13

```

## 8. Step 5 – Configure and Execute Model Fine-Tuning

### 8.1 Objective

The purpose of this step was to fine-tune the SinLlama model using the prepared training dataset. The supervised fine-tuning process was implemented using SFTTrainer and SFTConfig from the TRL library.

Two training runs were performed. The first run used the initial training configuration. After reviewing the training behaviour, three hyperparameters were modified for the second training run to apply stronger regularization and reduce the risk of overfitting.

The three modified hyperparameters were:

- Number of training epochs
- Learning rate
- Weight decay

### 8.2 Initial Training Configuration

The first training run was performed using the initial set of hyperparameters.

```

from trl import SFTTrainer, SFTConfig

# from transformers import TrainingArguments

print("Initializing SFTTrainer with Evaluation split...")

trainer = SFTTrainer(
    model=model,
    tokenizer=tokenizer,
    train_dataset=train_dataset,
    eval_dataset=eval_dataset,
    dataset_text_field="text",

```



```

max_seq_length=max_seq_length,

dataset_num_proc=2,

packing=False,

args=SFTConfig(

    per_device_train_batch_size=2,

    gradient_accumulation_steps=4,

    warmup_steps=5,

    num_train_epochs=3,

    learning_rate=2e-4,

    logging_steps=1,

    eval_strategy="steps",

    eval_steps=5,

    optim="adamw_8bit",

    weight_decay=0.01,

    lr_scheduler_type="linear",

    seed=3407,

    output_dir="outputs",

),

)

# Start training

print("Starting Fine-Tuning Process...")

trainer_stats = trainer.train()

print("\n--- Fine-Tuning Complete! ---")

```

| Parameter                   | Value        | Description                                                 |
|-----------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| per_device_train_batch_size | 2            | Number of training samples processed per device at one time |
| gradient_accumulation_steps | 4            | Accumulates gradients before performing a model update      |
| warmup_steps                | 5            | Number of warmup steps used at the beginning of training    |
| num_train_epochs            | 3            | Number of complete passes through the training dataset      |
| learning_rate               | 2e-4         | Controls the size of model weight updates                   |
| logging_steps               | 1            | Logs training information at every step                     |
| eval_strategy               | "steps"      | Performs evaluation during training based on training steps |
| eval_steps                  | 5            | Performs evaluation every 5 training steps                  |
| optim                       | "adamw_8bit" | Memory-efficient AdamW optimizer                            |
| weight_decay                | 0.01         | Regularization applied during training                      |
| lr_scheduler_type           | "linear"     | Uses a linear learning-rate scheduling strategy             |
| seed                        | 3407         | Used to support reproducibility                             |
| output_dir                  | "outputs"    | Directory used to store the training outputs                |



In the initial training configuration, the model was trained for **3 epochs** using a **learning rate of  $2e-4$**  and a **weight decay of 0.01**.

For the second training run, the number of training epochs was reduced from **3 to 1.5**. This reduced the number of complete passes through the training dataset.

The learning rate was reduced from  **$2e-4$  to  $4e-5$** , resulting in smaller and more gradual updates to the model parameters during fine-tuning.

The weight decay was increased from **0.01 to 0.1** to apply stronger regularization during training.

These three modifications created a more regularized training configuration for the second training run.

## 8.4 Second Training Run

The second training run was performed using the modified hyperparameters

```
from trl import SFTTrainer, SFTConfig

trainer = SFTTrainer(
    model=model,
    tokenizer=tokenizer,
    train_dataset=train_dataset,
    eval_dataset=eval_dataset,
    dataset_text_field="text",
    max_seq_length=max_seq_length,
    dataset_num_proc=2,
    packing=False,
    args=SFTConfig(
        per_device_train_batch_size=2,
        gradient_accumulation_steps=4,
        warmup_steps=3,
        num_train_epochs=1.5,
        learning_rate=4e-5,
        weight_decay=0.1,
        logging_steps=1,
        eval_strategy="steps",
        eval_steps=4,
        optim="adamw_8bit",
        lr_scheduler_type="cosine",
        seed=3407,
        output_dir="outputs_regularized",
    ),
)

trainer_stats = trainer.train()
```

### Modified Hyperparameters

The following three hyperparameters were changed compared with the initial training run:

- `num_train_epochs = 1.5`
- `learning_rate = 4e-5`
- `weight_decay = 0.1`

All other settings were configured according to the second training implementation.

## Training Execution

The second training run was started using:

```
trainer_stats = trainer.train()
```

The model was fine-tuned using the modified training configuration and the same prepared training and evaluation datasets.

```

Initializing SFTTrainer with Regularized Hyperparameters...
... Unsloth: Tokenizing ["text"] (num_proc=5): 100% ██████████ 113/113 [00:07<00:00, 17.03 examples/s]
Unsloth: Tokenizing ["text"] (num_proc=5): 100% ██████████ 13/13 [00:06<00:00, 2.22 examples/s]
Starting Regularized Training Run...
==((====))== Unsloth - 2x faster free finetuning | Num GPUs used = 1
  \  /  \  /  Num examples = 113 | Num Epochs = 2 | Total steps = 23
 O^O/ \_/ \  Batch size per device = 2 | Gradient accumulation steps = 4
 \  /  /  /  Data Parallel GPUs = 1 | Total batch size (2 x 4 x 1) = 8
  "-__-"  Trainable parameters = 41,943,040 of 8,162,971,648 (0.51% trained)
Unsloth: Will smartly offload gradients to save VRAM!
Unsloth: Double buffering enabled (parallel H2D + compute) for backward pass.
████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████ [23/23 07:42, Epoch 1/2]

Step  Training Loss  Validation Loss
-----
4      2.703060      3.023453
8      3.100867      3.005962
12     2.621047      2.987681
16     2.957149      2.976560
20     2.555419      2.971340
23     2.685392      2.970940

Unsloth: Restored added_tokens_decoder metadata in outputs_regularized/checkpoint-23/tokenizer_config.js
--- Training Complete! ---

```

## 8.5 Summary

The SinLlama model was fine-tuned using SFTTrainer with separate training and evaluation datasets. An initial training run was first performed using the original hyperparameter configuration. A second training run was subsequently conducted after modifying three hyperparameters: the number of training epochs, learning rate, and weight decay.

The modified configuration reduced the number of training epochs from **3 to 1.5**, reduced the learning rate from **2e-4 to 4e-5**, and increased weight decay from **0.01 to 0.1**. The outputs from both training runs can then be reviewed and compared using the training and evaluation results produced during execution.

## 9. Model Testing After Fine-Tuning

After training, the model is switched to inference mode and one sample from the evaluation split is selected for a direct generation test.

```

FastLanguageModel.for_inference(model)

test_noisy_text = eval_dataset[5]["input"]

test_prompt = alpaca_prompt.format(
    instruction="You are a Sinhala ASR correction system. Fix the spelling and grammar of the noisy input text
while preserving all numbers and context.",

```

```

        input=test_noisy_text,
        output=""
    )

inputs = tokenizer([test_prompt], return_tensors="pt").to("cuda")

outputs = model.generate(
    **inputs,
    max_new_tokens=512,
    use_cache=True,
    temperature=0.1
)

generated_text = tokenizer.batch_decode(
    outputs,
    skip_special_tokens=True
)[0]

```

The generated output displayed by the notebook contains the Alpaca prompt together with the model response because the complete generated sequence is decoded in this test cell.

```

# 1. Switch the model to 2x faster inference mode
FastLanguageModel.for_inference(model)

# 2. Pick a noisy text from your 10% Test Split
test_noisy_text = eval_dataset[5]["input"]

# 3. Format it using the exact Alpaca prompt used during training
test_prompt = alpaca_prompt.format(
    instruction="You are a Sinhala ASR correction system. Fix the spelling and grammar of the noisy input text while preserving all numbers and context.",
    input=test_noisy_text,
    output="" # Leave output blank for the model to generate
)

# Tokenize and generate
inputs = tokenizer([test_prompt], return_tensors="pt").to("cuda")
outputs = model.generate(
    **inputs,
    max_new_tokens=512,
    use_cache=True,
    temperature=0.1 # Keep it deterministic
)

# Print the result
generated_text = tokenizer.batch_decode(outputs, skip_special_tokens=True)[0]
print("--- MODEL OUTPUT ---")
print(generated_text)

```

... Both `max\_new\_tokens` (=512) and `max\_length` (=8192) seem to have been set. `max\_new\_tokens` will take precedence. Please refer to the documentation for more information. ([https://huggingface.co/docs/transformers/main/en/main\\_classes/text\\_generation](#))

```

--- MODEL OUTPUT ---
Below is an instruction that describes a task, paired with an input that provides further context. Write a response that appropriately completes the request.

### Instruction:
You are a Sinhala ASR correction system. Fix the spelling and grammar of the noisy input text while preserving all numbers and context.

### Input:
ඔය ම පිනකකි මට පුවත් සැවින්නහෙලෝ නටඹුන්න හෙලෝ පේඔබ් කියන්න සර් හෙලෝ ඔබ් මගේ රවුටර් බිල් එක මට දැන් මාස දෙක විතර ගෙවාගන්න බැරි වුනා මේ ම වෙනදට බිල් එක ගෙවන්න

### Response:
හෙලෝ, මට පුවත් ඔබට සහාය වන්න. හෙලෝ, මගේ රවුටර් බිල් එක මට දැන් මාස දෙකක් විතර ගෙවාගන්න බැරි වුණා. මම වෙනදට බිල් එක ගෙවන විදිහට කරගන්න විදිහක් නෑ. ඔන්

```

## 10. Model Evaluation

### 10.1 Evaluation Setup

The evaluation stage processes all 13 examples in the evaluation dataset. Predictions are generated using the same correction instruction, and the generated response is extracted after the '### Response:' delimiter before comparison with the reference output.

```

wer_metric = evaluate.load("wer")
cer_metric = evaluate.load("cer")

```

```

rouge_metric = evaluate.load("rouge")

predictions = []
references = []

for idx in range(len(eval_dataset)):
    noisy_input = eval_dataset[idx]["input"]
    true_clean_output = eval_dataset[idx]["output"]

    test_prompt = alpaca_prompt.format(
        instruction="You are a Sinhala ASR correction system. Fix the spelling and grammar of the noisy input text
while preserving all numbers and context.",
        input=noisy_input,
        output=""
    )

    inputs = tokenizer([test_prompt], return_tensors="pt").to("cuda")

    outputs = model.generate(
        **inputs,
        max_new_tokens=512,
        use_cache=True,
        temperature=0.1,
        pad_token_id=tokenizer.eos_token_id
    )

    full_output = tokenizer.batch_decode(
        outputs,
        skip_special_tokens=False
    )[0]

    generated_text = full_output.split("### Response: ")[-1]
    generated_text = generated_text.replace(
        tokenizer.eos_token, ""
    ).strip()

    predictions.append(generated_text)
    references.append(true_clean_output)

```

## 10.2 Evaluation Metrics

The notebook computes Word Error Rate (WER), Character Error Rate (CER), ROUGE-1, ROUGE-2, and ROUGE-L. WER and CER are lower-is-better measures, while ROUGE scores are higher-is-better overlap measures.

```

...
Completed 13 evaluation samples.

--- SAMPLE INSPECTION ---

[SAMPLE 1]
EXPECTED : ආයුබෝවන් මම තුෂාර්, මට පුළුවනි ඔබට සහය වන්න. ආයුබෝවන් මිස්, මගේ මේ නම්බර් එකේ කතෙක්කන් එක බ්ලොක් වෙලා තියෙනවා. ඒක පොඩ්ඩක් රිකතෙක්ව් කරගන්න.
PREDICTED: ආයුබෝවන්, මම තුෂාර්. මට පුළුවනි ඔබට සහය වන්න. ආයුබෝවන් මිස්, මගේ නම්බර් එක එක කතෙක්කන් එක වෙලා තියෙනවා. ඒක රිකතෙක්ව් කරගන්න ඕනේ. මම අද දෙ

[SAMPLE 2]
EXPECTED : ආයුබෝවන්, මම නිපුන්. කොහොමද සහය වෙන්න පුළුවන්? මිස්, අපේ PEO TV එකයි telephone line එකයි දෙකම වැඩි නැහැ. මිට දවස් දෙකකට කලින් ඇවිල්ලා හැදුවා. හැදුවත්
PREDICTED: ආයුබෝවන්, මම මරියා. මට පුළුවනි ඔබට සහය වන්න. පියෝ වීව් එකයි, මොබිටෙල් එකයි දෙකම වැඩි නැහැ. ඊයේ ඉඳන් වැඩි කළේ නැහැ. හැදුවත් ඒ විදිහටම ආයෙත් වෙලා ;

[SAMPLE 3]
EXPECTED : ආයුබෝවන්, මට පුළුවනි ඔබට සහය වෙන්න. ආයුබෝවන් මිස්, මම පියදර්ශනී. ඊයේ හවස ඉඳන් මිස් මේ අපේ ලයින් එක වැඩි කරන්නේ නැහැ. ටෙලිෆෝන් ලයින් එක වැඩි කර
PREDICTED: ආයුබෝවන් මම රමේෂ්. මට පුළුවනි ඔබට සහය වන්න. ආයුබෝවන් මිස්, අපේ ලයින් එක වැඩි කරන්නේ නැහැ. ෆෝන් ලයින් එක වැඩි කරන්නේ නැහැ. ඒ කියන්නේ ලයිව් එක (

```

```
=====
EVALUATION RESULTS
=====
Word Error Rate (WER):      0.8754 (Lower is better)
Character Error Rate (CER): 0.7006 (Lower is better)
-----
ROUGE-1 (Unigram match):    0.0398 (Higher is better)
ROUGE-2 (Bigram match):     0.0154 (Higher is better)
ROUGE-L (Sentence flow):    0.0370 (Higher is better)
=====
```

## 11. Model Export and Backup

### 11.1 LoRA Adapter Backup

```
model.save_pretrained("lora_backup")
tokenizer.save_pretrained("lora_backup")
```

```
print("Backup saved! You can download the 'lora_backup' folder.")
```

The notebook confirms successful creation of the LoRA backup with the message: 'Backup saved! You can download the lora\_backup folder.'

```
Unsloth: Restored added_tokens_decoder metadata in lora_backup/tokenizer_config.json.
Backup saved! You can download the 'lora_backup' folder.
```

---

## 12. Conclusion

The uploaded notebook implements an end-to-end training workflow for adapting SinLlama to Sinhala ASR text correction. The workflow covers environment preparation, 4-bit base-model loading, LoRA adapter configuration, JSONL dataset formatting, supervised fine-tuning, model testing, evaluation, GGUF export code, and LoRA adapter backup. The step-by-step structure in this document is intended to allow another team member to understand the implemented workflow and reproduce it using the same code, configuration, dataset, and trained resources.

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